

Closest to Tier 4 — MA Phone Policy Progress Report

Snapshot of the no-mistakes MA Power Map tracker. Generated 2026-05-23.

This report ranks Massachusetts public school districts by their distance to the Childhood Index gold standard for phone-free schools — **bell-to-bell + inaccessible storage + K-12 + all PEDs + narrow exceptions (IEP/504 + documented medical only)**. Each district below has been verified through district records + news + social media triangulation.

For each district, this report names the **exact change** that would clear the tier-4 bar — what to ask the school committee to revise.

Districts at Tier 4 (gold standard, today)

Pioneer Valley School District

Summary: SC unanimously adopted 2024-06-06, effective Aug 2024. Yondr magnetic pouches (INACCESSIBLE STORAGE — meets Childhood Index gold standard) across ALL 3 PVRSD schools: PVRSD (7-12), Bernardston Elementary, Northfield Elementary. K-12 within district footprint. Covers phones, smartwatches, earbuds, tablets — broader than phones. Featured in MA AG's Office statewide toolkit. SC Chair: 'accommodations can be made if absolutely necessary' (per Childhood Index: sup discretion is fine).

chIdx concerns still flagged (loopholes, but not disqualifying): - 'Accommodations can be made if absolutely necessary' — broad rather than specifying IEP/504/documental-medical (but per Childhood Index, sup discretion is fine)

Sources verified: 5 (district records + news + social media triangulation)

Mount Greylock School District

Summary: Policy JT (SC adopted 2024-07-22, effective Sept 2024): student-owned PEDs (phones, watches, tablets, earbuds, gaming, smart glasses) powered off and stored bell-to-bell across all 3 schools (LES, WES PreK-6, MGRS 7-12). Storage: lockers at MGRS/LES, front office at WES. Tiered consequences 1st-3rd offense + ISS. Principal discretion for medical or educational purposes (per Childhood Index spec, principal/sup discretion is fine).

chIdx concerns still flagged (loopholes, but not disqualifying): - `accessible_storage_lockers_at_MGRS_LES` (Childhood Index: lockers are explicitly NOT inaccessible enough; spec wants pouches/cabinets) - `educational_use_exception` (Policy JT §4 includes 'educational purposes' carve-out — flagged as weakening but not disqualifying)

Sources verified: 6 (district records + news + social media triangulation)

Closest to Tier 4 — Tier 3 districts

These districts have inaccessible-storage hardware policies but are held back by scope < K-12 or by specific weakening loopholes.

1. Nantucket School District

Enrollment ~1,653 · scope: 6-12 · enforcement: hardware

Strengths: - Yondr inaccessible-storage at 6-12 - Bell-to-bell at MS+HS - Unanimous SC vote - All PEDs covered

What needs to change to clear tier 4: - scope_lt_K12 (K-5 has off-and-away only)

Primary source: [Nantucket Public Schools — 2025-09-01](#)

2. Ipswich School District

Enrollment ~1,509 · scope: 9-12 · enforcement: hardware

Strengths: - Inaccessible caddy/cabinet storage at IHS - True bell-to-bell (no lunch/passing access) - AG named IHS as statewide model

What needs to change to clear tier 4: - scope_lt_K12 (HS only — K-8 has non-hardware bans)

Primary source: [Gloucester Daily Times — 2026-05-09](#)

3. Central Berkshire School District

Enrollment ~1,530 · scope: 6-12 · enforcement: hardware

Strengths: - Yondr inaccessible-storage at MS+HS - Bell-to-bell at MS+HS

What needs to change to clear tier 4: - scope_lt_K12 (K-5 not covered)

Primary source: [iBerkshires — 2025-08-03](#)

4. Martha's Vineyard School District

Enrollment ~703 · scope: 9-12 · enforcement: hardware

Strengths: - Yondr inaccessible-storage at MVRHS - Bell-to-bell

What needs to change to clear tier 4: - scope_structurally_HS_only (NCES confirms MVRHS is sole school under this district ID)

Primary source: [Martha's Vineyard Times — 2024-08-21](#)

5. Greenfield School District

Enrollment ~1,285 · scope: varies · enforcement: hardware

Strengths: - Yondr inaccessible-storage at GMS+GHS - Bell-to-bell at MS+HS - Hardware enforcement

What needs to change to clear tier 4: - scope_lt_K12 (K-5 has off-and-away only) - open-ended principal accommodation broader than IEP/504/medical-with-documentation

Primary source: [Greenfield Public Schools — 2025-10-01](#)

6. Newton School District

Enrollment ~11,462 · scope: K-8-Yondr-bell-to-bell-HS-class-period-only · enforcement: mixed-Yondr-K8-non-locking-HS

Strengths: - K-8 bell-to-bell with INACCESSIBLE Yondr storage (tier-4-internal for that grade band) - Universal restroom/locker-room ban all grades - Annual SC policy review built into policy - Public enforcement narrative (Nolin) reports compliance success - Consent-required photo/video rule - Chromebook social-media + game blocks - School wifi filters social media - Funded enforcement (mayoral earmark, ~\$50K/yr)

What needs to change to clear tier 4: - HS_NOT_bell_to_bell (phones allowed at lunch, passing, outside buildings) - Newton_North_uses_non_locking_shoe_organizer_pouches_easily_defeated - open_campus_exits_make_HS_locking_impractical_by_design - no_standalone_NPS_policy_code_handbook_defers_to_individual_school_policy

Primary source: [GBH — 2025-08-28](#)

7. Watertown School District

Enrollment ~2,843 · scope: K-12 · enforcement: mixed

Strengths: - K-12 scope in policy text - Bell-to-bell language (first bell to dismissal incl. lunch and breaks) - All PEDs covered (phones, smartwatches, headphones, tablets, laptops, gaming) - Unanimous SC adoption (May 4 2026) - Doorman software pilot signals operational seriousness

What needs to change to clear tier 4: - storage_method_not_mandated (policy leaves choice to each level — could be accessible at K-5) - doorman_software_not_hardware (per Childhood Index spec, hardware/inaccessible storage is the gold standard) - not_yet_in_operation (effective Sept 2026)

Primary source: [Watertown News — 2026-05-05](#)

8. Abington School District

Enrollment ~2,132 · scope: varies · enforcement: off-and-away

Strengths: - MS bell-to-bell - Storage by bin/locker/teacher collection

What needs to change to clear tier 4: - HS_class_only_with_lunch_passing_access - scope_mixed_not_K12_bell_to_bell

Primary source: [Abington Public Schools \(MA\) — 2025-08-01](#)

9. Athol-Royalston School District

Enrollment ~1,567 · scope: varies · enforcement: hardware

Strengths: - Yondr inaccessible-storage at 7-12 - Bell-to-bell at MS+HS

What needs to change to clear tier 4: - scope_lt_K12 (PK-6 inclusion not verified) - 504 not enumerated as exception

Primary source: [Athol Daily News — 2025-08-24](#)

10. North Adams School District

Enrollment ~1,064 · scope: tiered-K-12 · enforcement: hardware-9-12-off-and-away-K-8

Strengths: - Pouch system at Drury HS - K-8 off-and-away enforcement

What needs to change to clear tier 4: - tiered_K-8_off_and_away_not_hardware - admin_discretion_‘unless_explicitly_approved’

Primary source: [North Adams Public Schools — 2025-08-29](#)

11. Monson School District

Enrollment ~800 · scope: 7-12 · enforcement: hardware

Strengths: - Yondr plan adopted 2022 (per board minutes)

What needs to change to clear tier 4: - scope_lt_K12 (7-12 only) - no_post_rollout_confirmation_2023_plus

Primary source: [Monson Public Schools — 2022-09-08](#)

12. Wareham School District

Enrollment ~1,949 · scope: 9-12-class-only · enforcement: hardware

Strengths: - Portable lock-box at WHS

What needs to change to clear tier 4: - scope_HS_only_class_only - lunch_passing_access_at_HS_2024_policy

Primary source: [Wareham Week — 2024-05-17](#)

13. New Bedford School District

Enrollment ~12,441 · scope: 6-12-Yondr-K-5-TBD · enforcement: hardware

Strengths: - Bell-to-bell at 6-12 (NBHS + Normandin + Roosevelt + Keith) - INACCESSIBLE Yondr storage - Covers PEDs broadly - Covers academic + non-academic spaces (hallways, gym, auditorium, bathrooms, athletic fields) - District-wide consistency across HS + all 3 MS - Documented consequence ladder

What needs to change to clear tier 4: - scope_K_5_not_confirmed (likely soft off-and-away) - carve_outs_for_medical_need_announced_but_protocol_not_yet_in_handbook - SY24_25_rollback_history (responsive to student pushback — weakening risk) - no_published_consequences_ladder_yet_for_new_Yondr_era

Primary source: [New Bedford Light — 2025-06-13](#)

14. Chicopee School District

Enrollment ~6,616 · scope: secondary-schools-only · enforcement: hardware

Strengths: - Yondr inaccessible-storage at 3 secondary schools since 2022

What needs to change to clear tier 4: - scope_lt_K12 (MS + 9 elementaries not covered) - educational_use_exception ('closely aligned with course content') - after_school_activities_exception

Primary source: [GovTech — 2023-09-13](#)

15. Chelsea School District

Enrollment ~5,749 · scope: 6-12-partial · enforcement: hardware

Strengths: - Yondr at CHS + Browne MS

What needs to change to clear tier 4: - scope_lt_K12 (4 elementaries not covered) - wider_MS_rollout_not_confirmed_per_school - emergency_magnet_admin_discretion

Primary source: [Chelsea Record — 2025-10-16](#)

Notable Tier 2 districts

These districts have policies on the books but lack inaccessible-storage hardware. The Childhood Index spec considers off-and-away (pockets, backpacks, lockers) materially weaker than removal-from-possession (Yondr, locked cabinets).

1. Lee School District

Enrollment ~648 · scope: 6-12 · enforcement: off-and-away

Why it's tier 2: - pockets_with_off_is_NOT_hardware (Eagle editorial explicitly contrasts Lee with hardware-using McCann/Lenox) - extraordinary_emergency_carve_out (admin-discretion exception beyond medical/IEP/504)

Existing strengths: - Bell-to-bell 7:58a-2:30p time window codified - Smartwatches/AirPods/headphones included in scope - Berkshire Eagle editorial praised consistency

2. Brookline School District

Enrollment ~6,948 · scope: K-12 · enforcement: mixed-non-hardware

Why it's tier 2: - accessible_storage (off-and-away at K-8, no hardware) - BHS allows phones during passing time and free blocks (NOT bell-to-bell) - no_unified_K12_policy (school-by-school pilots)

Existing strengths: - K-8 schools have some policy (off-and-away pilots) - BHS adopted Rule 1.4 April 10 2025 (SC formal action) - Policy text published in handbook

3. Cohasset School District

Enrollment ~1,382 · scope: varies · enforcement: off-and-away

Why it's tier 2: - confiscation_on_violation_not_hardware (NO Yondr/pouch — phones stay on student) - principal_conversation_first_enforcement (Principal Scott told SC enforcement = conversation, not discipline) - discretionary_admin_approval ('other situations with prior administrative approval' is broader than medical/IEP/504)

Existing strengths: - CHS policy unanimous 3-0 SC vote - MS 'Away for the Day' since 2018-19 (long-standing) - Both schools cover all-day, all-spaces

4. Littleton School District

Enrollment ~1,632 · scope: K-12-non-hardware · enforcement: off-and-away

Why it's tier 2: - NO_hardware_storage_anywhere (no lockers, caddies, pouches at any school) - LHS_permits_phones_during_study_hall_lunch_passing_teacher_discretion (broad in-school permission) - original_entry_referenced_Colorado_Littleton (data-quality flag)

Existing strengths: - LMS prohibits use during school day - Smart watch policy distinct from phone policy

5. Boston School District

Enrollment ~44,416 · scope: K-12-off-and-away-with-school-by-school-Yondr-overlay · enforcement: two-track: district off-and-away + ~31/125 schools Yondr opt-in

Why it's tier 2: - off_and_away_NOT_inaccessible_storage (baseline policy permits backpack/pocket retention) - Yondr_is_school_by_school_opt_in_not_district_mandate (~25% of schools as of fall 2025) - no_uniform_district_consequence_schedule (school-site councils set their own) - no_Superintendent_Circular_dedicated_to_PEDs (policy lives in school-site rules) - BSAC_student_petition_against_Yondr_1200_signatures (student-side resistance)

Existing strengths: - District-wide off-and-away policy since 2005 (long-standing) - \$850K Yondr contract 2024-2027 (operational investment) - Boston City Council Sept 2025 resolution backs bell-to-bell - Cellphone Policy Working Group formed Oct 2025 — Spring 2026 recommendation

6. Framingham School District

Enrollment ~8,482 · scope: FHS-9-12-classroom-only · enforcement: off-and-away

Why it's tier 2: - accessible_storage (backpack or wall caddy — NOT locked) - lunch_passing_access (FTA president explicitly confirms loophole) - scope_only_FHS_9_12 (K-8 + 9 elementaries not documented) - no_hardware_storage_anywhere

Existing strengths: - FTA leadership publicly advocates statewide bell-to-bell legislation - House Education Chair represents this district - FHS reports consistent enforcement at HS level

7. Lynn School District

Enrollment ~15,877 · scope: K-12-incl-lunch-hallways · enforcement: off-and-away

Why it's tier 2: - NO_hardware_storage_anywhere - leadership_turnover_during_rollout (Alvarez resigned Oct 2025) - staff_discretion_dependent_off_and_out_of_sight - union_pushback_on_cafeteria_scope (potential weakening risk)

Existing strengths: - Whole-day scope including lunch + hallways (stronger than typical tier 2) - K-12 not HS-only - Explicit progressive-discipline ladder with alternatives to suspension

8. Springfield School District

Enrollment ~23,574 · scope: K-12-bell-to-bell-time-but-accessible-storage · enforcement: off-and-away-at-district-level-Yondr-at-Central-HS-only

Why it's tier 2: - Storage_accessible_in_student_possession (fails Tier 4 inaccessible-storage standard) - Yondr_school_by_school_not_district_wide (~8% of district enrollment at Central HS) - Policy_last_revised_2013_12_years_stale - No_public_confirmation_of_Sci_Tech_Putnam_Renaissance_or_middle_school_Yondr - Enforcement_inconsistent_in_practice_despite_paper_bell_to_bell

Existing strengths: - District policy explicitly defines 'academic school day' as bell-to-bell IN TIME SCOPE - Dual-consent photo guardrail (stronger than typical) - Aggressive escalation (in-house suspension by 3rd offense; 1-month device hold for repeated) - SC Central HS Yondr program mature (since fall 2022)

9. Hudson School District

Enrollment ~2,275 · scope: varies-no-hardware · enforcement: off-and-away

Why it's tier 2: - NO_district_JICJ_policy (never adopted) -

HHS_allows_lunch_passing_before_after (not bell-to-bell at HS) - no_hardware_anywhere (no Yondr/pouches) - policy_was_cross_state_hallucination (on-file claim matched Hudson NH JICJ verbatim — corrected)

Existing strengths: - Quinn MS bans phones during school day - HHS has classroom 'dedicated space' storage during class

10. Ludlow School District

Enrollment ~2,158 · scope: varies-MS-only-Yondr · enforcement: mixed

Why it's tier 2: - split_district_policy (BMS Yondr, LHS no Yondr) -

LHS_softer_policy_not_brought_to_board (LHS has instructional-time policy without hardware) - administrative_not_board_policy (BMS Yondr was admin decision, not SC vote) - documented_student_workaround (pouches broken by slamming magnet)

Existing strengths: - BMS has bell-to-bell Yondr since fall 2024 - CTEC was earliest Yondr adopter in district

Statewide advocacy intel — where the leverage is

Across the 37 red-team-verified districts in this tracker, the most common barriers to tier 4 cluster as follows. Each row tells the ED which lever moves the most districts forward.

- **11× scope_lt_k12** — Athol-Royalston School District, Cambridge School District, Central Berkshire School District, Chelsea School District, Chicopee School District, +6 more
- **11× scope_lt_K12** — Athol-Royalston School District, Cambridge School District, Central Berkshire School District, Chelsea School District, Chicopee School District, +6 more
- **6× accessible_storage** — Boston School District, Brookline School District, Framingham School District, Mount Greylock School District, Watertown School District, +1 more
- **6× no_hardware** — Brockton School District, Brookline School District, Framingham School District, Hudson School District, Littleton School District, +1 more
- **4× lockers** — Littleton School District, Lowell School District, Mount Greylock School District, Worcester School District
- **4× no_yondr** — Cohasset School District, Hudson School District, Ludlow School District, Worcester School District
- **4× lunch_passing_access** — Abington School District, Framingham School District, Quincy School District, Wareham School District

- 3× `hs_only` — Ipswich School District, Martha’s Vineyard School District, Wareham School District
 - 3× `student_workaround` — Brockton School District, Cambridge School District, Ludlow School District
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Methodology

- All entries red-team verified across **district records** (school committee minutes, BoardDocs, district handbooks), **news coverage** (local papers, regional outlets, statewide press), and **social media** (Facebook, X, Reddit, student newspapers).
- Tier system anchored to the **Childhood Index / Distraction-Free Schools Policy Project Model Bill** spec.
- Federal medical / IEP / 504 accommodations are allowed at every tier; superintendent / principal discretion is allowed at tier 4; emergency-use and educational-use exceptions are flagged as loopholes but not auto-disqualifying.
- The **Statewide mandate (S.2561)** takes effect September 1, 2026 — all MA public school districts will be required to implement bell-to-bell phone-free policies. This report tracks who’s ahead of that mandate and who has the strongest implementation today.

— Generated by the MA Power Map red-team. Source: <https://allaire-matthew.github.io/ma-power-map/>